

The Leftover 2.5 Is Not an Area Law. Held-Out Rods Miss by Five.

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Abstract

Paper 64 left a residual: slab grow is 2.5, not 3. This note asks whether

$$\delta S = aV + bA$$

is a universal area term, or shape junk.

$N = 12$. Balls, cubes, slabs, rods. $\alpha = 0.01, 0.02, 0.04$. In-sample two-term rel RMS 0.081, 0.073, 0.066. Volume-only is the same to two digits. Leave-one-family-out: held-out rods miss by 5.2. The area coefficient flips sign when slabs are withheld. Auditor $N = 10$: gain and LOO refuted.

There is no Clausius/horizon handle in this residual. Sea-transfer δS is volume-like with $O(1)$ shape junk. Gravity remains $\sum \delta e$ plus inherited Gauss.

Admission. *I hoped grow $\neq 3$ was an area term. Leave-one-family-out killed it. I did not move C_{loo} .*